

STARS@SLU 2026

ORIENTATION



SAINT LOUIS
UNIVERSITY.
— EST. 1818 —

Program Norms

1. Treat everyone with respect
2. Be present and engaged
3. Share talk time
4. Listen to understand
5. Everyone has expertise
6. Critique ideas, not people
7. Embrace discomfort
8. Normalize time to think / process
9. Contribute equally to all discussions, group work, and activities



Respect

Getting to know each other



Özlem Uğurlu
Director



Bryan Clair
Co-director



Mehak Garg
*Graduate Assistant
and Mentor*



Daniel Lee
*Undergraduate
Assistant & Mentor*



Deo Reji
*Undergraduate
Assistant & Mentor*



Preetinder Kaur
*Undergraduate
Assistant & Mentor*

Introduce yourselves; including name, school and grade!



Let's learn more about each other.

STARS@SLU 2026 Meet

What gif reflects best your spring semester?

+

ozlemugurlu 3 minutes ago



What emoji describes best how you're feeling today?

+

ozlemugurlu 8 minutes ago



Finish a project the night before it's due or start it two weeks early - which one are you?

+

What's something everyone else seems to love that you just don't get?

+



Outline of the Program

01

Week 1

Hands-on R-workshops
Sessions on Professional Growth
Mentoring sessions
Invited Speakers
Game Sessions
Campus Tours

02

Week 2

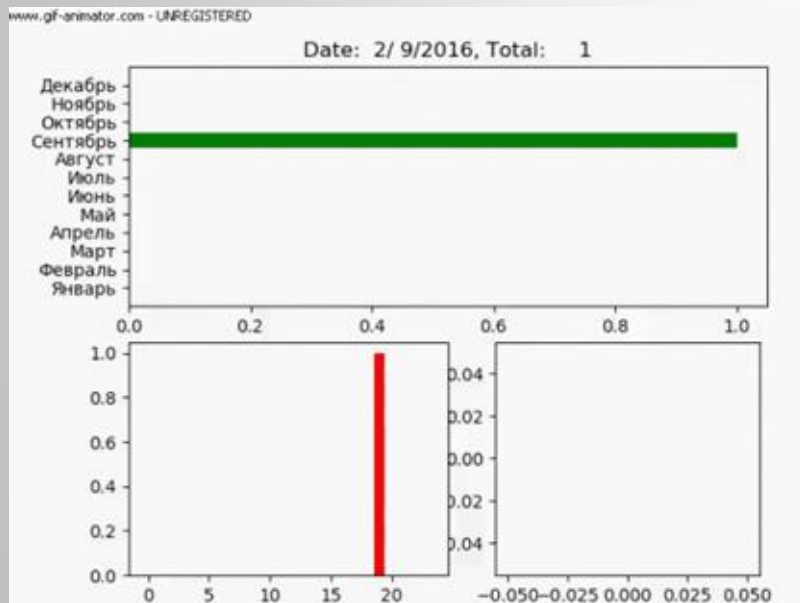
Group Projects
Poster Preparation Sessions
Mentoring Sessions
Invited Speakers
Game Sessions

03

Last Day

Poster Presentation
Certificate of Completion
Closing Remark & Reception

Research



- **In the first week**, you will attend a workshop series, two 1.5-hour sessions per day.
- The topics will include basic R usage, data cleaning and manipulation with dplyr, and data visualization with ggplot2.
- You will learn to create statistical and graphical summaries of data.
- **At the end of the first week**, you will be introduced to potential research projects and team up based on your shared interests.
- **Throughout the second week**, you will work in small groups on collaborative projects under the supervision and guidance of mentors.

Mentoring



Student mentors will support you through the program

Mentoring helps you:

- Build confidence and navigate challenges
- Develop a stronger sense of belonging in mathematical community
- Gain access to resources, networks, and opportunities
- Learn from someone who has been in your shoes

This is your support system. You're not alone in this journey.

↓ Professional Growth

Learning and development opportunities through dedicated sessions.

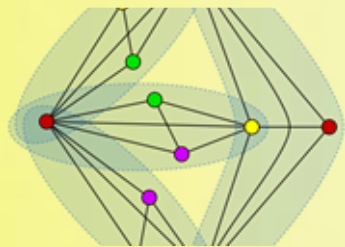
At a glance

- How to build a Resume
- How to apply to a College
- How to prepare a good poster
- Mental Health





Game Sessions



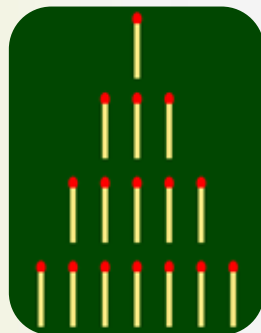
01

Function Battleship



02

The Game of Set



03

The Game of Nim



04

Instant Insanity

05

Planar Graphs



Invited Speakers



01

Psychology

[Dr. Christopher Schmank](#)



02

Health and Clinical Outcomes

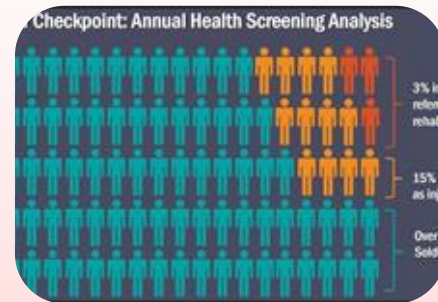
[Dr. Tong Si](#)



03

Physical Therapy and Athletic Training

[Dr. Olu Owoeye](#)



04

GeoSpatial Science and Computer Science

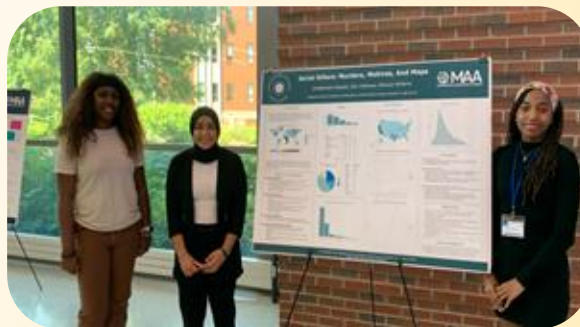
[Dr. Vasit Sagan](#)



Poster Presentation

- Sports, Health and Performance
- Healthcare and Medical
- Social Equity & Public Health
- Space and Astronomy
- Economics and Finance
- And more ...

See the projects on our website:
<https://stars-slu.github.io/homepage/>



Project details

Preparation Due Date: Make sure to prepare your posters by
Thursday, June 11th, 3PM

Putting up the posters:
Friday, June 12th, Noon - 1PM

Location: SSEC Lobby

Poster Session:
Friday, June 12th, 1-2pm

Feel free to invite anyone you'd like!

Checklist

01

Logistic

Breakfast:

In front of SSEC 230

Sessions & Workshops:

SSEC 230

Lunch: Grand Dining Hall

Picnic on Wednesdays

02

Stipend and Travel Support

Stipend & Travel:

Your information was shared with the Post Award Specialist, Sara Baumann. Expect an email from her.

Email:

sara.bauman@slu.edu

Posting on
Social
Media?
Tag MAA!

#MAAGrants
#MAAPrograms
#MAA
#MathGrants

03

Signed Forms

1. SLU Photo Release Form
2. Liability Waiver
3. Health Medical Release Form
4. **Community Agreement Form**

04

Program Materials

All the materials will be available on GitHub site:
stars-slu.github.io/2026/



What is Next for the day?

01



Workshop - Part I

Team or lead: Led by Dr. Bryan Clair and Student Assistants

Objective: Connect to Posit.cloud and begin using R. Learn base R functionality. Learn RStudio features

Time: 10 - 11:30 am

02



Workshop - Part II

Team or lead: Led by Dr. Bryan Clair and Student Assistants

Objective: Install packages and load libraries. Use simple **dplyr** verbs and pipes. Read data from files.

Time: 12:30 - 2:00 pm

03



Mentoring Session

Team or lead: Led by Student Assistants

Objective: Meeting with mentors, setting goals

Time: 2:15 - 3:15 pm

04



Campus Tour

Team or lead: Will be led by Visit SLU Staff, starting from the ISE building

Objective: Explore the SLU North Campus

Time: 3:30 - 4:30 pm

On Wednesday we will order PIZZA for Lunch - Fill the form to let us your preference!



Thank you



Questions?

